cultural baggage that the immigrants themselves brought from the Middle East, Africa, and Asia. Nevertheless,k the influence of a strongly anti-Israel European media cannot be ignored either.

France offers perhaps the most revealing barometer for the current crisis of European Jewry and the "new" antisemitism in the EU, containing as it does approximately 8 million Muslims (about 10–12% of the French population) and 500,000 Jews—the largest Jewish community on the Old Continent. Incredibly, more than 40% of *all* racist acts committed on French soil in 2014 were directed at Jews, who represent less than 1% of the overall population.[9] Contrary to various myths about widespread "Islamophobia," Jews are incomparably more likely than Muslims to be the objects of a hate-crime (this is also true of Britain, Canada, and the United States). Furthermore, the perpetrators of these violent anti-Jewish assaults and harassment in countries like France, Belgium, Holland, the UK, or Sweden are far more frequently Muslims than neo-Nazis or far-right extremists.

Fance has once again seen the largest escalation of anti-Jewish violence in recent years in Europe with pro-Palestinian mobs laying siege to several synagogues in central Paris on the eve of the French Bastille celebrations (13 July 2014). The bulk of the protesters were of North African Arab origin (*Maghrébins*) with a motley groups of allies from the Left, including Communists, trade unionists, ecologists, leftists, and the militant anti-Zionists of the Trotskyist New Anti-Capitalist Party (NAP). The protesters surrounded one synagogue, filled with about 200 congregants who had to barricade themselves inside. Several persons were injured as the mob, in a pogrom-like atmosphere, shouted chilling slogans like "Death to the Jews," and "Hitler was right," while trying to force its way into the building. In Belleville, an eastern suburb of Paris, loud chants of "Slaughter the Jews" could also be heard in Arabic at a pro-Hamas demonstration. Another synagogue was firebombed on 11 July in Aulnay-sur-Bois during Friday night services. Earlier the same day, in broad daylight near the Gare du Nord railway station, a 17-year-old Jewish girl was insulted and pepper-sprayed by a young Arab man shouting: "Dirty Jews, God willing (*inshallah*), you will die."[10] A few days later, in Sarcelles, a Parisian suburb with a mixed Arab-Jewish population, an Arab mob attacked Jewish-owned shops—destroying a pharmacy, a pizzeria, and several stores, burning cars and attacking Jews outside a synagogue, which the rioters tried unsuccessfully to set alight. French police had to use water cannons, tear gas, and rubber bullets in scenes reminiscent of a Middle East intifada.

Despite the valiant efforts promoted by French Prime Minister Manuel Valls (supported by Bernard Cazeneuve, the Interior Minister and President

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,